before, as he had been asleep after a long and difficult day. He went on to say that he had always spoken to me with frankness and that he now wanted to tell me how deeply offended he felt by the tone of my letter following the two telephone conversations.

> I would have understood perfectly well were it written after our first talk, in which you voiced anger and in which you also hurt me personally and deeply, especially through the use of the word “Holocaust,” of which I know some facts which may be unknown to my fellow man . . . but after the second conversation, you ended it with the words, “Menachem, Shalom.” How can I have shalom of mind having now read your written message?

Referring to my assertion that the new Israeli military campaign in northern Lebanon might make impossible further changes in the package being negotiated by Habib, and that Israel therefore would have to accept it as is, Begin said: “We shall not accept any package agreement if we are not fully consulted about the contents before the package is wrapped up.” As for the new Israeli offensive, he said:

> Everywhere in Lebanon where our forces are, is related to our determined right to stamp out the scourge of terrorism; it has nothing to do with our resolve to withdraw our forces from Lebanon simultaneously, as Mr. Habib put it to me at his own initiative, with the departure of the foreign Syrian forces.
>
> Sincerely,
>
> Menachem Begin

During the next two weeks, Habib finally got all sides to agree on our plan, which provided for a new cease-fire,